Universal Human Values – II (UHV-II)

Module 1 · Session 5 — Student Activity Worksheet

Lecture 5 — Happiness and Prosperity: Current Scenario

Session	5	**Lecture**	Lecture 5
Topic	Happiness and Prosperity — Current Scenario (excitement vs happiness, sources of happiness, prevailing notions)		
Name	MD ZAID	**Reg. No.**	RA2511026010522
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Session Learning Outcomes

By the end of this session, the student should be able to:

- Distinguish happiness from excitement and escape.
- Explain the three sources of happiness and their continuity/dependence.
- Examine prevailing notions about happiness and prosperity.

How to Engage with this Session (The Process)

- Whatever is said is a proposal — do not assume it to be true or false.
- Verify it on your own right, on the basis of your natural acceptance.
- It is a dialogue: first with the teacher, then within your own self — between what you are and what you really want to be.

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap)

- Every human being aspires for continuous happiness; the program adopted depends on what is understood or assumed.
- Happiness = harmony, does not depend on the outside, can be continuous; excitement depends on the outside and is momentary.
- Three sources of happiness: right understanding and right feeling (ensured in self, continuous) and sensation (through body, temporary).
- Escapes such as over-eating, addiction, etc. give only temporary escape, not happiness.
- Accumulation of wealth is not the same as prosperity — that is a prevailing misconception.

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Excitement or Happiness?

For each source, mark whether it is continuous & independent (happiness) or temporary & dependent (excitement).

Source	Continuous / independent OR temporary / dependent
Right understanding (in the self)	Continuous / independent
Right feeling — ensured in the self	Continuous / independent
Favourable sensation (tasty food, music…)	Temporary / dependent
Attention / appreciation from others	Temporary / dependent

Activity 2 — Sources of Happiness

Complete the table from the session.

Source	Ensured in self / from other / through body	Continuous or temporary?
Right understanding	Ensured in self	Continuous
Right feeling	Ensured in self (and expressed to other)	Continuous
Sensation	Through body (and from other)	Temporary

Activity 3 — Respond to a Prevailing Notion

Pick one and write your response after today's discussion:

- “I will be bored of happiness if I am always happy.”
- “The richer you are, the more prosperous you are.”

Accumulating wealth does not equate to prosperity. Prosperity is a feeling derived from recognizing how much physical facility is required and possessing more than that limit. Without right understanding, even wealthy individuals experience a feeling of deprivation and continue to hoard.

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Distinguish between happiness and excitement, with reference to the three sources of happiness.

Happiness: Inner harmony arising from right understanding and right feelings within the Self. It is independent of external circumstances and can be continuous.

Excitement: Temporary sensory stimulation or emotional highs resulting from external inputs. It depends on factors outside the self and is followed by exhaustion or frustration.

Three Sources Context: Right understanding and right feelings in the self generate continuous, self-organized happiness. Sensation through the body provides temporary excitement that cannot be sustained continuously

Q2. Examine the prevailing notion that “accumulation of wealth = prosperity.”

The notion that accumulating wealth equals prosperity is incorrect. Wealth consists of physical items, whereas prosperity is a feeling within the Self.

Accumulating physical facilities without assessing actual needs leads to greed, fear, and environmental exploitation. True prosperity requires assessing physical needs accurately and producing/obtaining more than required

Q3. Explain why dependence on sensation, on physical facility, and on feeling received from others cannot give continuous happiness, and what the role of sensation actually is.

Limitations of External Sources:

- **Sensation:** Sensory pleasures are temporary; repeated exposure leads to boredom or physical distress.
- **Physical Facility:** Serves body needs but cannot satisfy the internal needs of the Self.
- **Feelings from Others:** Relying on external validation makes happiness dependent on others, causing instability and enslavement.

Actual Role of Sensation: Sensation serves as an information channel between the Self and the Body to keep the body healthy and facilitate interaction with the physical world.